NERC
NORTH AMERICAN ELECTRIC RELIABILITY CORPORATION

Agenda
Emerging Large Loads Technical Conference

February 24, 2026 | 9:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. Eastern | Join Webinar – Day 1
February 25, 2026 | 9:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. Eastern | Join Webinar – Day 2

Renaissance Arlington Capital View Hotel
2800 Potomac Ave, Arlington, VA 22202

Call to Order and Safety Briefing

NERC Antitrust Compliance Guidelines and Participant Conduct Policy

February 24 - Data Center Risks and Current Industry Action

The first day of the conference aims to build a shared understanding of reliability risks associated with rapid data center growth and to highlight actions being taken by industry stakeholders and NERC to address those risks. The program will inform participants of NERC recommendations for risk mitigation and identify opportunities for further collaborative actions to address current and emerging challenges. These outcomes will prepare attendees for the technical engagements and forward-looking actions planned for Day two.

Agenda Items

8:00-9:00 a.m. Optional Breakfast

1. **9:00-9:05 a.m. Administrative Briefing** – NERC Staff
2. **9:05-9:15 a.m. NERC Welcome** – Jim Robb, President and CEO, NERC
3. **9:15-9:25 a.m. Opening Remarks** – Kal Ayoub, Director of the Office of Electric Reliability, FERC
4. **9:25-9:40 a.m. Keynote** – Bill Fehrman, Chairman of the Board, President, and CEO, AEP
5. **9:40-9:55 a.m. Keynote** – Dado Slezak, Executive Vice President, Utility Innovation, QTS Data Centers
6. **9:55-10:10 a.m. Keynote** – Suzanne Keenan, Chair of the NERC Board of Trustees

10:10-10.30 a.m. Break

7. **10:30-12:00 p.m. Panel – Data Center Industry Initiatives to Address Grid Reliability –** Moderated by Hasala Dharmawardena, Senior Engineer, NERC
   a. Anurag Jivanani, Vice President Global R&D Data Center Systems, Schneider Electric
   b. Janne Paananen, Data Center Systems Architect, Eaton
   c. Mike Della Penna, Data Center Transmission Planning & Analysis, Google
   d. Doug Golden, Vice President, Power, Core Scientific Inc.
   e. Chris Ruppel, Director of Distributed Energy Resources and Energy Origination, MARA

12:00-1:00 p.m. Lunch

8. **1:00-2:15 p.m. Panel – Utility Approaches to Improve Reliability when Integrating Data Centers –** Moderated by Rich Bauer, Principal Engineer, NERC
    a. Katelynn Vance, Manager, Electric Transmission Planning & Strategic Initiatives, Dominion Energy
    b. Patrick Gravois, Principal Operations Engineer, ERCOT
    c. Kevin Conway, Senior Manager of Non-Tariff Programs, Western Power Pool (WPP)
    d. Tom Pierpoint, Vice President of Operations, Northern Virginia Electric Cooperative
    e. Matt Twardy, Engineer, Integrated Transmission Planning – West, Xcel Energy
9. **2:15-3:05 p.m. NERC Reliability Guideline and White Papers – Large Loads Working Group (LLWG)**
    a. Assessment of Gaps in Existing Practices, Requirements, and Reliability Standards for Emerging Large Loads – Jack Gibfried, Engineer II, NERC
    b. Reliability Guideline: Risk Mitigation for Emerging Large Loads – Evan Mickelson, Engineer II, NERC
10. **3:05-3:20 p.m. Remarks –** Alex Fitzsimmons, Acting Under Secretary of Energy and Director of the Office of Cybersecurity, Energy Security, and Emergency Response, U.S. Department of Energy

3:20-3.30 p.m. Break

11. **3:30-5.00 p.m. Super Panel – Pathways to Address Unmitigated Risks from Data Center Grid Integration** – Moderated by JP Skeath, Manager, Engineering & Security Integration, NERC
    a. Mike Della Penna, Data Center Transmission Planning & Analysis, Google
    b. Janne Paananen, Data Center Systems Architect, Eaton
    c. Anurag Jivanani, Vice President Global R&D Data Center Systems, Schneider Electric
    d. Chris Ruppel, Director Energy Development, MARA
    e. Doug Golden, Vice President, Power, Core Scientific Inc.
    f. Katelynn Vance, Manager, Electric Transmission Planning & Strategic Initiatives, Dominion Energy
    g. Patrick Gravois, Principal Operations Engineer, ERCOT
    h. Kevin Conway, Senior Manager of Non-Tariff Programs, WPP
    i. Tom Pierpoint, Vice President of Operations, NOVEC
    j. Matt Twardy, Engineer, Integrated Transmission Planning – West, Xcel Energy
    k. Rich Bauer, Principal Engineer, NERC

February 25 – Modeling and Study Risks: Practical Actions for Reliable Grid Operation

The program on the second day is expected to address the reliability impacts of computational load, including co-located data centers and generation, and to focus on modeling and study needs, and practical next actions to support reliable grid operation.

8:00-9:00 a.m. Optional Breakfast

12. **9:00-9:45 a.m. Keynote – Addressing the Risk of Emerging Large Loads: The Way Forward –** Mark Lauby, NERC Fellow and Chief Engineer
    a. This keynote will focus on sharing information on the NERC Large Load Action Plan and associated next steps, including reliability considerations related to computational load and the role of registration.
13. **9:45-11:00 a.m. Panel – Data Centers: The Reliability Perspective –** Moderated by JP Skeath, NERC
    a. Mark Lauby, NERC Fellow and Chief Engineer, NERC
    b. Diego Rodriguez, Technical Solutions Lead, Reactive Technologies
    c. Chris Pilong, Sr. Director, Operations Planning, PJM
    d. David Molteni, Senior Manager, Digital Modernization, Constellation
    e. Eric Mannarino, Design Delivery Principal, Electrical Engineering, Equinix
    f. Tom Galloway, President and CEO, NATF

11:00-11.15 a.m. Break

14. **11:15-12:30 a.m. Panel – Modeling and Studying Data Center Impact on Power Systems –** Moderated by Patrick Harwood, Senior Engineer, NERC
    a. Katelynn Vance, Manager, Electric Transmission Planning & Strategic Initiatives, Dominion Energy
    b. Eric Meier, Supervisor, Planning Model Administration, ERCOT
    c. Jay Senthil, Senior Key Expert, Siemens PTI
    d. Lakshmi Sundaresh, Engineer, EPRI

12:30-1:30 p.m. Lunch

15. **1:30-2:00 p.m. Keynote – NERC Registration: Doorway to Membership in the World's Largest Machine** – Howard Gugel, Senior Vice President, Regulatory Oversight, NERC
    a. This keynote will focus on how the NERC registration function helps ensure Bulk Power System reliability. It will also cover the value of registration in NERC, explain how registration helps industry, and reliability for consumers across North America.

16. **2:00-2:45 p.m. Preliminary insights from the NERC Alert 2** – JP Skeath, NERC

2:45-3.00 p.m. Break

17. **3:00-4.30 p.m. Immediate Next Steps for Addressing Emerging Large Load Reliability Risks** – Soo Jin Kim, Vice President, Standards and Registration, NERC
18. **4.30-5.00 pm – Closing Remarks** – Latrice Harkness**,** Director, Engineering, NERC